

Who Pays and Who Decides: Pressure Builds

谁承担，谁决定：压力上升

Theme: 社会问题、经济与公共生活 · New: 44 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 44/6,127

English Story

The pressure built when the **government** changed the **funding** rule for the water **utility**. “The **state** will not carry the **maintenance** of a plant that the **market** cannot **finance**,” the minister said. “A **dollar** of **public money** has to buy a **right**, not a habit.” The **declaration** was short and the **objection** was long.

The **social** argument was harder than the **economic** one. “A **policy** that works in the **capital** does not work in a **community** of four thousand,” a **sociologist** said. “The **wealth** of a **society** is not the same as the **wealth** of a **sector**.” The **left** wing of the council and the **liberal** bloc both claimed the phrase as their own.

The **civil** question was who counted as a **citizen**. “A **tax** on water is not the same as a fee,” a **socialist** economist wrote. “One is a **bill**, the other is a **bail** for a **utility** that has already failed once.” The **legal** opinion on the table said the two could not be separated.

The **popular politics** of the moment made the **economics** harder. “The **market** is not a **democracy**,” the mayor said, “and the **interest** of the taxpayer is not the **interest** of the **citizen**.” A dozen rates, four audits, and one red line across the page: the argument had a real shape at last.

The pressure from the banks was simple: a **declaration** of **socialism** would close the credit line. “A **dollar** of **funding** deferred is a **dollar** of **maintenance** lost,” the treasurer said. The republican member disagreed, and so did the **socialist** member, and both of them were **right**.

The act of the council was to hold the rate, off the record and on the condition of a second audit. “We can talk about capitalism later,” the mayor said. “The pipe under this street will not wait.” The pressure had produced a decision, and the decision had produced the next pressure. The act of the council, the order of the day, and the real support of the four wards: all of it was on the record. Free water for the poor, a red line for the rich, and a republican objection from the **left**: the talk had a shape at last, and the issue was no longer off the table. The **law** was **federal**, the **economy** was local, and the **citation** of **Marxism** in a footnote about **imperialism** was, as one member said, a remark about **civilisation** rather than about the water **bill**. The only action left to the council was to wait, and the low point of the debate was still ahead.

中文翻译

当政府修改水务公用事业的资金规则时，压力就累积起来了。“国家不会承担一家市场无法融资的工厂的维护费，”部长说，“一美元公共资金必须买来一项权利，而不是一个习惯。”那份宣告很短，而异议很长。

社会层面的论证比经济层面的更难。“一项在首都有效的政策，在四千人的社区里无效，”一位社会学家说，“一个社会的财富不等于一个部门的财富。”议会的左翼和自由派集团都把这句话当成了自己的。

市民层面的问题是谁算作公民。“对水征的税和对水收的费不是一回事，”一位社会主义派经济学家写道，“一个是账单，另一个是为一家已经失败过一次的公用事业公司的保释金。”桌上的法律意见书说，两者无法分开。

当时的流行政治让经济问题更难。“市场不是民主，”市长说，“纳税人的利益不等于公民的利益。”十二种费率、四次审计，以及横跨页面的一条红线：这场论证终于有了真实的形状。

来自银行的压力很简单：一份社会主义的宣告会关掉授信额度。“被推迟的一美元资金，就是失去的一美元维护，”司库说。共和派成员不同意，社会主义派成员也不同意，而两个人都是对的。

议会的法案是维持费率不变，不记录在案，并以第二次审计为条件。“资本主义我们可以晚点再谈，”市长说，“这条街下面的管子不会等。”压力促成了一项决定，而这项决定又催生了下一轮压力。议会的法案、当日的议程，以及四个选区真正的支持：全都在记录上。给穷人的免费水、给富人的一条红线，以及来自左翼的一位共和派的反对：这场谈话终于有了形状，而这个问题不再被搁在桌下。法律是联邦的，经济是地方的，而在一篇关于帝国主义的脚注里引用马克思主义，正如一位成员所说，是一句关于文明的评论，而不是关于水费的。议会剩下的唯一行动就是等待，而这场辩论的低点还在前面。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
government 'gʌvənmənt POS: n	n. 政府, 内阁; [经] 政府, 政治, 政体 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the organization that is the governing authority of a political unit; n. the act of governing; exercising a...
state steɪt POS: n	n. 州, 状态, 情形, 国家, 政府, 领土, 国务, 社会地位; a. 国家的, 正式的, 礼仪用的, 州的; vt. 说明, 陈述, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the territory occupied by one of the constituent administrative districts of a nation; n. the way something...
right raɪt POS: n	n. 权利, 右边, 正义, 右派, 公正; a. 正确的, 对的, 恰当的, 正常的, 正直的, 正面的, 右方的; adv. 正确地, 以... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an abstract idea of that which is due to a person or governmental body by law or tradition or nature; it i...
social 'seʊʃəl POS: a	a. 社会的, 群居的, 社交的; n. 联欢会 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. relating to human society and its members; a. living together or enjoying life in communities or organized...
interest 'ɪntrɪst POS: n	n. 兴趣, 嗜好, 利息, 利益, 爱好, 趣味, 势力; vt. 使感兴趣, 与...有关系 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a sense of concern with and curiosity about someone or something; n. the power of attracting or holding one...
money 'mʌni POS: n	n. 金钱, 一笔款, 财富, 货币, 金额; [经] 货币, 金钱, 财产 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the most common medium of exchange; functions as legal tender; n. wealth reckoned in terms of money; n. the...
policy 'pɒlɪsi POS: n	n. 政策, 方针, 策略, 保险单; [医] 凭单, 保险单 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a plan of action adopted by an individual or social group; n. a line of argument rationalizing the course o...
market 'mɑ:kɪt POS: n	n. 市场, 交易, 集市, 推销地区, 行情, 市面, 销路; vt. 在市场上交易, 使上市, 销售; vi. 在市场上买卖 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the world of commercial activity where goods and services are bought and sold; n. the customers for a parti...
law lɔ: POS: n	n. 法律, 法则, 定律, 法律的制约, 法学, 司法界, 诉讼; v. 起诉 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the collection of rules imposed by authority; n. legal document setting forth rules governing a particular...
community kə'mju:nɪti POS: n	n. 社区, 公众, 共有, 共同体; [经] 公众, 共有, 社会 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a group of people living in a particular local area; n. common ownership; n. a group of nations having commo...
public 'pʌblɪk POS: n	n. 公众, 民众; a. 公众的, 公共的, 公立的, 公用的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a body of people sharing some common interest; a. not private; open to or concerning the people as a whole; ...
society sə'saɪəti POS: n	n. 社会; 社交界; 交往; 社团 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an extended social group having a distinctive cultural and economic organization; n. the fashionable elite
economic .ɪ:kə'nɒmɪk POS: a	a. 经济上的, 实用的, 节省的; [经] 经济的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to an economy, the system of production and management of material wealth; a. of or relating...
federal 'fedərəl POS: a	a. 联邦的, 联合的, 同盟的; [法] 联邦的, 联邦制的, 联盟的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a member of the Union Army during the American Civil War; n. any federal law-enforcement officer; s. nationa...
tax tæks POS: n	n. 税, 税款, 重负, 会费; vt. 课以税, 使负重荷, 斥责 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. charge against a citizen's person or property or activity for the support of government; v. levy a tax on; v...
economy 'i:kənəmi POS: n	n. 经济, 理财, 节约; [医] 经济, 整体 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the system of production and distribution and consumption; n. the efficient use of resources; n. frugality i...
capital 'kæpɪtəl POS: n	n. 首都, 大写字母, 资本; a. 首都的, 重要的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. assets available for use in the production of further assets; n. wealth in the form of money or property ow...
legal 'li:ɡəl POS: a	a. 法律的, 法定的, 合法的; [经] 法定权利; 法律(上)的, 合法的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. established by or founded upon law or official or accepted rules; a. of or relating to jurisprudence; s. hav...
left left POS: a	a. 左边的, 左倾的, 左侧的, 左派的; adv. 在左面; n. 左, 左面, 左派; leave的过去式和过去分词 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. location near or direction toward the left side; i.e. the side to the north when a person or object faces...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
bill bil POS: n	n. 帐单, 清单, 钞票, 鸟嘴, 广告, 法案, 票据; vt. 开帐单, (用招贴)宣布 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a statute in draft before it becomes law; n. an itemized statement of money owed for goods shipped or servi...
sector 'sektə POS: n	n. 扇形, 部门, 部分, 函数尺, 象限仪, 段, 区段; vt. 把...分成扇形; [计] 扇面; 扇区; 段; 区段 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a plane figure bounded by two radii and the included arc of a circle; n. a social group that forms part of...
popular 'popjule POS: a	a. 通俗的, 流行的, 受欢迎的, 大众的, 人民的, 普及的; [经] 大众的, 通俗的, 普及的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. regarded with great favor, approval, or affection especially by the general public; s. carried on by or for...
politics 'politiks POS: n	n. 政治, 政治学, 政见, 政治活动; [法] 政治, 政治学, 政纲 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. social relations involving intrigue to gain authority or power; n. the study of government of states and ot...
civil 'sivəl POS: a	a. 市民的, 公民的, 有礼貌的; [法] 公民的, 国民的, 民用的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. applying to ordinary citizens as contrasted with the military; a. not rude; marked by satisfactory (or espe...
citizen 'sitizn POS: n	n. 市民, 公民; [法] 公民, 国民, 市民 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a native or naturalized member of a state or other political community
democracy di'mokrəsi POS: n	n. 民主政治, 民主主义; [法] 民主, 民主政治, 民主政体 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the political orientation of those who favor government by the people or by their elected representatives; ...
finance faɪ'næns POS: n	n. 财政, 财务; vt. 供给...经费, 负担经费; vi. 筹措资金 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the commercial activity of providing funds and capital; n. the branch of economics that studies the managem...
liberal 'libərəl POS: n	n. 自由主义者; a. 慷慨的, 不拘泥的, 宽大的, 自由主义的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who favors a political philosophy of progress and reform and the protection of civil liberties; n. ...
funding 'fʌndɪŋ POS: review required	[经] 债务转期 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n financial resources provided to make some project possible; n the act of financing; v convert (short-term flo...
maintenance 'meɪntənəns POS: n	n. 维护, 保持, 维修, 生活费用, 坚持, 扶养; [计] 维护; 维修 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. means of maintenance of a family or group; n. the unauthorized interference in a legal action by a person h...
wealth welθ POS: n	n. 财富, 资源, 财产, 丰富, 富裕, 大量; [经] 财富 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of being rich and affluent; having a plentiful supply of material goods and money; n. the quality...
dollar 'dɒlə POS: n	n. 美元, 元(加、澳等国货币单位); [经] 纯经济的, 美元, 元 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the basic monetary unit in many countries; equal to 100 cents; n. a piece of paper money worth one dollar; n...
socialist 'səʊʃəlɪst POS: n	n. 社会主义者, 社会党党员; [法] 社会主义的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a political advocate of socialism
utility ju:'tɪlɪti POS: n	n. 功用, 有用之物, 实用, 公用事业, 实用程序; a. 实用的, 有多种用途的; [计] 实用程序, 工具 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a company that performs a public service; subject to government regulation; n. the quality of being of prac...
economics .i:kə'nɒmɪks POS: n	n. 经济学; [经] 经济学 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the branch of social science that deals with the production and distribution and consumption of goods and...
objection əb'dʒekʃən POS: n	n. 异议, 反对, 不喜欢, 缺点, 缺陷, 妨碍, 拒绝之理由; [法] 异议, 反对, 抗议 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the speech act of objecting; n. (law) a procedure whereby a party to a suit says that a particular line of...
declaration .deklə'reɪʃən POS: n	n. 宣告, 说明, 宣布; [计] 说明 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a statement that is emphatic and explicit (spoken or written); n. (law) unsworn statement that can be admit...
socialism 'səʊʃəlɪzəm POS: n	n. 社会主义, 社会主义运动 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a political theory advocating state ownership of industry; n. an economic system based on state ownership o...
bail beɪl POS: n	n. 保释, 铃环, 杓, 栅栏; vt. 保释, 舀水 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (criminal law) money that must be forfeited by the bondsman if an accused person fails to appear in court...
sociologist .səʊsi'ɒlədʒɪst POS: n	n. 社会学家; [法] 社会学家 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a social scientist who studies the institutions and development of human society

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
civilisation ,sivilai'zeifən;-li'z- POS: n	n. 文明, 文明世界, 文化, 开化, 教化 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the social process whereby societies achieve an advanced stage of development and organization; n a particul...
Marxism 'mɑ:ksizm POS: n	n. 马克思主义; [法] 马克思的, 马克思主义的; 马克思主义 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the economic and political theories of Karl Marx and Friedrich Engels that hold that human actions and ins...
citation sai'teifən POS: n	n. 引用, 引证, 引用文; [建] 引证, 指引 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an official award (as for bravery or service) usually given as formal public statement; n. (law) the act of...
imperialism im'piəriəlizm POS: n	n. 帝国主义, 帝制; [法] 帝国主义 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a policy of extending your rule over foreign countries; n. a political orientation that advocates imperial...